DAY 17 · THEORY HANDOUT

Teach the Answer Pattern With Examples

Use zero-shot, one-shot, and few-shot prompts on the same small task.

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The idea and its useful terms

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Use zero-shot, one-shot, and few-shot prompts on the same small task.

Zero-shot

Give the task
with no worked example.

One-shot

Add one example
of input and answer.

Few-shot

Add a few examples
of the answer pattern.

Examples show the model how labels and formats work. They can reduce guesswork when an instruction is unclear.

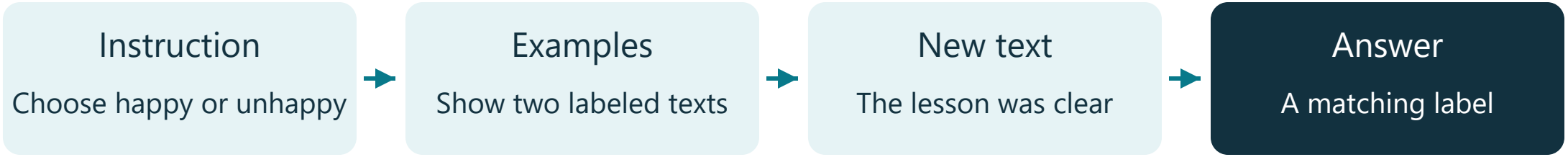
These examples sit in the prompt. They do not train or change the model's saved weights.

> More examples use more input space. Good examples matter more than a long list of repeated ones.

Follow the work, one step at a time

Each step has a job. We can inspect its output before moving on.

Read the path from left to right.



Each arrow means: pass the result to the next step.

First state the classification task. Then show an input and its expected label. Put the new input after the examples, without its answer. The model predicts a label using the pattern in this prompt.

Examples should show the cases we expect to meet. Two happy examples do not explain unhappy well. Keep test sentences outside the examples so the comparison measures a new input.

> If the answer is wrong, inspect the input and the intermediate results. The last sentence alone cannot show which step failed.

A small example we can check

The values here are classroom examples. The notebook shows actual results.

Example 1

I liked this class.

Label: happy

Example 2

The sound was unclear.

Label: unhappy

New input

The class helped me.

Model chooses a label.

Read the given input first. Point to the fact or value needed for the requested output.

Run the matching example, then try the fresh input at the end of the notebook. Compare both results with the known input.

> More examples use more input space. Good examples matter more than a long list of repeated ones.

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Choose the setting or tool for its job

A different choice changes the work. These are the choices we compare.

Pick examples

Show more than one class.

Use short, clear text.

Check labels

A wrong example can teach the wrong answer pattern.

Keep a test set

Test on fresh sentences.

Do not copy the examples.

Try no examples, one example, and two examples on the same new sentences.

Count matching labels rather than judging one nice-looking answer.

> Add a difficult sentence such as "The slides were good but the sound was bad." Check the limit of two labels.

Practice, check, and read the full lesson

Use the notebook to try the steps. Use the article when you need the longer explanation.

1. Build

Run the small example.

Inspect each step.

2. Change

Try the fresh input.

Keep the goal clear.

3. Check

Compare with the source.

Keep mistakes visible.

Add a difficult sentence such as "The slides were good but the sound was bad." Check the limit of two labels.

Read the complete tutorial breakdown for this section in our KGP Talkie article.

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DAY 17 · COMPLETE

Thank You

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